

Safety needs + concerns

worksheet for patient's letter of medical necessity (LMN) preparation

Your loved one's OT/PT will write the LMN, but having the below information and being able to discuss your concerns about the topics is integral to their understanding of the total picture of the need for an enclosed bed. Please complete the worksheet and bring it to your OT/PT evaluation.

How important is the letter of medical necessity?

The letter is critical for your approval or denial. It must justify, per your individual insurance plan's coverage requirements for an enclosed bed, why the Cubby Bed is the best product to address your loved one's safety concerns. LMNs are typically written by an Occupational Therapist or Physical Therapist.

What should be included in the LMN?

The letter needs to include:

- Your loved one's diagnosis/diagnoses
- Safety concerns
- Less costly alternatives that were tried and the reasons they did not work
- Features of the Cubby Bed that will address these safety concerns (see LMN guide)

Tips for writing a strong LMN:

- Use firm, decisive language. Avoid vague wording like "could be a risk." For example, rather than stating that your loved one 'may' sustain injury from head-banging, use clear language to convey potential safety concerns associated with repetitive behaviors like head-banging.
- Detail the specific risks to your loved one. While eloping is inherently dangerous, your letter will be stronger if you illustrate these risks. Paint the picture of the concerns that warrant an enclosed bed as a solution.
- Document safety concerns with as many specific details as possible, including any dangerous incidents that have occurred and whether your loved one was seen by a provider as a result.
- Include any supporting documents, if available, such as medical bills.

On the next page, detail each safety concern and discuss it with your loved one's provider. The details discussed on the Safety Needs and Concerns Worksheet should be documented in your loved one's medical record. If the information is not in their record, request that the provider add it to the chart notes to increase your chance of coverage. All safety concerns should be specific to the patient and may include things like seizure activity, elopement, head-banging, fall risk, ingesting non-edible items, incontinence, entrapment, burrowing and other self-injurious behaviors.

Patient's name: _____

Safety concern 1: _____

- How often does it occur? _____
- What less expensive solutions have you tried to prevent it and why did it/they not work?

- Safety feature of the Cubby Bed that will assist in minimizing this concern:

Safety concern 2: _____

- How often does it occur? _____
- What less expensive solutions have you tried to prevent it and why did it/they not work?

- Safety feature of the Cubby Bed that will assist in minimizing this concern:

Safety concern 3: _____

- How often does it occur? _____
- What less expensive solutions have you tried to prevent it and why did it/they not work?

- Safety feature of the Cubby Bed that will assist in minimizing this concern:

Safety concern 4: _____

- How often does it occur? _____
- What less expensive solutions have you tried to prevent it and why did it/they not work?

- Safety feature of the Cubby Bed that will assist in minimizing this concern:

Safety concern 5: _____

- How often does it occur? _____
- What less expensive solutions have you tried to prevent it and why did it/they not work?

- Safety feature of the Cubby Bed that will assist in minimizing this concern:
